



Choosing Your Opportunity



The Insight

What is the entrepreneurial insight of the venture? That is, the thing the venture understands that few people understand.

The facade cleaning industry is largely outdated that are highly labour intensive and risky. While other drone clean

Why here and now? Why does this insight present a novel opportunity for this time and place? Why has nobody previously sought to exploit this idea or, alternatively, why has it failed in the past?

Stricter EU environmental laws and increasing manual labor costs have made traditional cleaning methods risky and expensive. Simultaneously, the facility management industry is actively seeking automated, compliant solutions, creating an urgent market demand for our technology.



Unfair Advantage

Why you? What individual perspectives, experiences, and/or networks do you bring to the opportunity that will increase your likelihood of success? What steps could you take to expand your skill set, experience, and network to assist you in realizing this opportunity?

First- hand observations living in Germany. Prev



Passion

Why you? What is it about this opportunity that excites you? Specifically, what are your primary motivations and broad objectives in pursuing this opportunity? How will your passion, values, and commitment drive how you realize this opportunity?

We are driven by safety and sustainability. We want

Choosing Your Strategy (A First Look)

This worksheet helps you explore and understand the process of forming strategic paths, testing, exploring, and making a choice around a core idea. It helps you see how you should Test Two, before you Choose One.



Core Idea

State your core so that it describes a solution and does not include other important choices.
Describe what the venture is doing.

Briefly describe (or reiterate) your entrepreneurial motivation, passion, and unfair advantage.

Motivation	Smart drone-based façade cleaning for commercial buildings in DACH with an active rotary brush for targeted micro-cleaning & significant less water usage. It cleans building facades while simultaneously capturing thermal data to detect building condition for maintenance and provide automated report.
Passion	
Unfair advantage	

Potential Strategic Paths



Describe at least two potential strategic paths for your core idea.

Strategic Path 1

We operate the business as a cleaning c

Strategic Path 2

We operate as a hardware/software service supplier. We focus on R&D and manufacturing. We lease the drone system to Facility Management Service Firms (e.g., Wisag, Strabag) so they can use it to clean their clients buildings.



Compare

What are the key differences between these two strategic paths? Why can't the entrepreneurs do both at the same time? What will they learn about in one strategy but not in the other (and vice versa)?

Test

What test could the founding team run to choose between these alternatives?
Does doing one or the other impose costs on pivoting?



Describe Key Differences

Now it is time to choose.

Between the two strategies, which strategy helps the entrepreneur(s) achieve their broader reasons for becoming an entrepreneur (i.e., entrepreneurial passion) and leverages their experience (“unfair advantage”)?

Which strategy is the most straightforward to implement and allows the entrepreneur to “just do it”?

Choose One!

Once you have gathered this information, you will make your choice! We explore the final actions of choice in Chapter 13.



Choosing Your Customer

1

INHERENT VALUE

Identify & Prioritize Potential Beachheads

Identify a short list of potential beachhead customers for whom the venture could **create value**.

Beachhead Market	How could the venture create value for this potential customer?	What alternatives (imperfect solutions) already exist for this customer's needs?
Facility/Property Management of Commercial and Public Institutions in DACH	- reduces wastewater, solving the liability issue of chemical runoff. - provid	- Manual Rope Access- Suspe
Facility management agencies	enhance their value proposition by enabling them to offer "Green, Safe, & Data-Driven" facade cleaning to their existing clients without needing to build the tech themselves. We solve their labor shortage crisis and increasing profit-margin.	- Manual Rope Access- Suspe
Wind Farm Operators (Windmill Cleaning)	active mechanical brushes can remove sticky residue and heavy surface roughness. The system can be adapted for de-icing applications.	- Manual Rope Access- "Tou
Solar Farm Managers (Photovoltaic Cleaning)	Supports "soft wash" techniques (low pressure + agitation), which is the industry preferred method for protecting anti-reflective coatings on solar glass.	- Wheeled robots- "Touchless"
Aviation Maintenance Providers (Aeroplane Cleaning)	Supports "soft wash" techniques (low pressure + agitation), Aerial Physical Interaction (APhI) technology allows the drone to maintain contact with curved structure.	- Truck mounted Cradles- Ma

Prioritize the top four potential customers based on relative value creation.

- A Facility/Property Management of Commercial and Public Institutions in DACH (beachhead market) represents a ~€2 Billion TAM. It is feasible and cost-effective for the venture to acquire these customers because venture solves specific, high-cost administrative, logistics and regulatory "headaches" for Facility Managers.
- B Facility management agencies (DACH) represents a ~€2 Billion TAM. It is feasible and cost-effective for the venture to acquire these customers because it will enabling them to offer "Green, Safe, & Data-Driven" facade cleaning to their existing clients without needing to build the tech themselves. We solve their labor shortage crisis and increasing profit-margin.
- C Solar Farm Operators (DACH) represents a €100M TAM. It is feasible and cost-effective for the venture to acquire these customers because Lower technical barrier, regulatory complexity, Easier drone operation and more frequent cleaning cycles, annual contracts possible.
- D Wind Farm Operators (DACH) represents a €160M TAM. It is feasible and costeffective for the venture to acquire these customers because high revenue per asset, performance-driven customer, Annual contracts possible.



Choosing Your Customer

2

STRATEGIC VALUE

Strategically Rank Beachhead Alternatives

Gauge opportunities for **learning** from each beachhead market.

Assess the strength of each beachhead as a **reference** for the mainstream market.

A

This potential beachhead will generate the following learning opportunities (about the customer/technology/organization/market) that will be valuable as the venture moves to the mainstream _____

Overcome environmental compliance-free workflows and refine digital reporting features, provides the necessary data to perfect GPS-navigation.

B

Selecting Facility Management agencies as a beachhead offers critical validation for the "Data-as-a-Service" revenue model, confirming whether the mainstream market will value digital verification reports to automate invoice auditing.

C

Serving solar farm operators allows the venture to perfect its "soft-touch" force-feedback control and autonomous path-planning.

D

Operating in the high-altitude, high-wind environments of wind farms allows the venture to stress-test its tethered power systems and stability algorithms against extreme weather, ensuring the drone's robustness.

A

This customer group will facilitate access to the desired follow-on markets because _____

prove that mechanical scrubbing outperforms touch-less spraying in high-rise buildings.

This potential beachhead may limit the transition to the mainstream market because _____

heavily driven by strict regional environmental laws, drone flying laws, certifications and compliances.

B

successfully navigating the strict regulations and removing the heavy urban s

C

This customer group will facilitate access to the desired

D

This customer group will facilitate access to the desired follow-o

Eliminate one potential beachhead before moving forward to step 3. Briefly explain your reasoning.

This potential beachhead may limit the transition to the mainstream market because cleaning requirements for turbines are fundamentally different and also high-wind-turbulnace problem would be difficult to solve on the first run. Again, in order to enter this market, navigation using LiDAR and radar needs to mastered and would be logistically very expensive to provide very long thethering system for avg. 150m height of wind turbines.



Choosing Your Customer

3

EXPLORING OPTIONS

Narrow & Investigate Your Choices

Conduct **commitment-free learning** about the three remaining beachhead candidates.

Beachhead Candidate #1: Facility/Property Management of Commercial and Public Institutions in DACH

The venture can test the value creation hypothesis associated with choosing this customer by...

Interviewing Managers: Find out the financial impact time-consuming logistics and the frequency of cleaning to esta

Beachhead Candidate #2: Facility management agencies

The venture can test the value creation hypothesis associated with choosing this customer by...

Interviewing Managers: Interview the Sustainability or Safety Officer of an FM agency regarding their current wastewater disposal documentation. Determine if the inability

Beachhead Candidate #3: Solar Farm Operators

The venture can test the value creation hypothesis associated with choosing this customer by...

Interviewing Managers: Find out the financial impact of "soiling losses" and the frequency of panel damage from man

Notes:



Choosing Your Technology

1

TECHNOLOGICAL REQUIREMENTS

Determine the Role of Technology in Value Creation

List potential technologies the venture may leverage to create value.

Technology	How does the technology contribute to value creation?	How would the venture access this technology?
Drone Platform	Stable close-contact facade operation	Commercial drones + customization
Physical Contact Cleaning	Removes heavy dirt & algae effectively	In-house mechanical development
Water Control System	Low water use, targeted cleaning	In-house mechanical development
Sensors & Cameras	Precision, safety, visual proof	Commercial sensor modules
Digital Reporting Platform	Compliance, documentation	Cloud-based software tools

Identify existing technologies and systems (if any) that the venture's product and/or operations must interface with effectively.

The venture's product and/or operations will have to be compatible with building façade materials and structural surfaces (technology/system) to create value for the customer because ...

safe, non-damaging cleaning is required.

The venture's product and/or operations will have to be compatible with EU and local drone aviation regulations (technology/system) to create value for the customer because ...

legal and insured operation is mandatory.

The venture's product and/or operations will have to be compatible with customer digital reporting and facility management systems (technology/system) to create value for the customer because ...

service results must be documented.



Before proceeding, determine whether a robust technology strategy is necessary.

- If the venture will be primarily leveraging technology developed by other firms (perhaps, in new ways, e.g., Warby Parker, Airbnb, Rent the Runway), you have finished the exercise. Please stop here for technology choice and consider the choices and requirements from Step 1.
- If the venture will be actively shaping technological innovation and developing new technologies (e.g., Tesla, Genentech), continue on to the next steps of technology choice. These steps will focus on alternative development approaches for your key technology.



Choosing Your Technology

2

KEY TECHNICAL APPROACHES

Consider Alternate Development Approaches for Key Technology

Identify key performance metrics for value creation based on the venture's technological requirements.

A key performance metric that customers will evaluate the venture by is cleaning effectiveness because ...

because façades must be visibly and thoroughly cleaned.

A key performance metric that customers will evaluate the venture by is operational safety because ...

because risk to workers and buildings must be minimized.

Identify three technical approaches that currently achieve or may in the future achieve the key performance metric(s).

Technical Approach	Manual facade cleaning (scaffolding)	Spray-based cleaning drones	Physical-contact cleaning drones
Current Level of Performance	High cleaning quality	Moderate cleaning quality	High cleaning effectiveness
Rate of Performance Improvement (nascent, rapidly improving, plateauing)	Plateauing	Rapidly improving	Nascent
Advantage of Using this Approach	Reliable and well understood	Fast deployment, low labor	Deep cleaning with low risk
Key Limitation of this Approach	High cost, safety risk and long operational time	Limited effectiveness on heavy dirt	Higher technical complexity

Before moving forward to step 3, eliminate one potential technical approach. Briefly explain your reasoning.

Manual façade cleaning is eliminated because it involves high safety risk, high labor cost, and poor scalability compared to drone-based solutions.



Choosing Your Technology

3

DEVELOPMENT TIMELINES

Assess Alternate Technical Development Timelines

Consider alternative technological trajectories for the remaining technical approaches.

Technical Approach #1:

Spray-based cleaning drones

Technical Approach #2:

Physical-contact cleaning drones

Exploiting the technology involves going-to-market with existing (or only slightly improved) levels of technological performance. Is this adequate for value creation? What can be done in the short-term to improve performance? What are the risks of exploiting this technology?

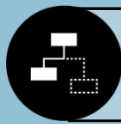
Existing performance is adequate for I

Existing performance is emerging and sho

Exploring the technology allows for further research and development. What performance improvements could be achieved over a longer timeline? What intermediate steps and/or milestones are required in the short-term in order to progress along this timeline? What are the risks of exploring this technology?

Performance improvements include

Performance improvements include a



Choosing Your Organization

1

RESOURCES AND CAPABILITIES

Identify & Prioritize for Value Creation

Identify a list of key resources and capabilities required to create value.

Resources/Capabilities	How does the resource/capability contribute to value creation?
Intangible Asset: First-hand Facility Management Knowledge	One founding team member works within a large corporate campus facility management team, with direct exposure to service evaluation cycles, vendor screening processes, and contract renewal criteria. This provides privileged insight into how facility managers assess risk, cost, compliance, and documentation—directly informing our service design and go-to-market approach.
Robotics & Drone Systems Design Capability	Two founding members with a microelectronics and robotics engineering background conduct research at a German research institute, working with advanced sensors and visual AI. This enables the development and evaluation of drone-assisted cleaning solutions that outperform “touchless” spray drones in heavily polluted urban environments.
Human Capital: Multidisciplinary Founding Team	The founding team combines facility management domain knowledge, advanced robotics engineering, commercial excellence & digital systems expertise, and behavioral science (psychology), forming a rare, non-replicable early-stage resource base.
Digital Commercialization & Go-to-Market Capability	The team possesses strong capabilities in CRM systems, agile project management, digital marketing, SEO, Google Ads, analytics, and event-based B2B marketing—allowing efficient customer acquisition, data-driven iteration, and scalable commercialization in the DACH market.
Service System Integration Capability	Beyond cleaning execution, the team can design an end-to-end “Cleaning-as-a-Service” system, integrating operational delivery with digital documentation, reporting, and performance insights—directly addressing customer demands for auditability and transparency.
User-Centered Design & Stakeholder Communication Capability	With a psychology-trained team member and project experience across disciplines, the team is able to translate complex robotics and automation concepts into trust-building, risk-aware narratives that resonate with conservative, cost-focused facility decision-makers.

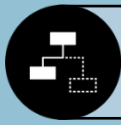
Prioritize two key resources/capabilities that are most essential for value creation.

First-hand Facility Management Knowledge (key resource/capability) is essential for value creation because ...

This resource is essential for value creation because it directly reduces the liability of newness by embedding the venture inside the customer’s decision-making reality. It ensures that the service is designed around real procurement constraints, risk perceptions, and evaluation criteria, rather than hypothetical customer needs.

Cross-functional Team Capability (Engineering × Operations × Commercial) (key resource/capability) is essential for value creation because ...

This capability is essential for value creation because the venture’s value proposition depends on tightly integrating technology, compliance, and service execution. Without a cross-functional team capability, the solution would risk becoming either a technically impressive but commercially irrelevant drone, or a market-driven concept without technological defensibility.



Choosing Your Organization

2

MAKE OR BUY

Assess Internal Development Versus External Acquisition

MAKE

Assess the venture's ability to develop critical resources and capabilities.

BUY

Consider the venture's ability to acquire critical resources and capabilities.

Critical Resource/Capability #1: Proprietary High-Access Mechanical Cleaning Capability (Deep Urban Cleaning)

Developing this key resource/capability requires ...

- Mechanical and robotic engineering expertise to design active brush-based cleaning

Acquiring this key resource/capability through the market necessitates ...

- provide design to mass drone manufactures to p

Potential challenges and disadvantages of developing this resource/capability internally are ...

- Higher upfront R&D cost and longer development cycles.- T

Potential challenges and disadvantages of acquiring this resource/capability externally are ...

- Limited cleaning effectiveness in dense urban environm

Critical Resource/Capability #2: Digital Cleaning-as-a-Service System (Documentation, Diagnostics & Insights)

Developing this key resource/capability requires ...

- Software and data capabilities to generate digital service reports, inc

Acquiring this key resource/capability through the market necessitates ...

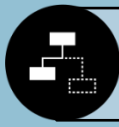
- Using generic inspection or reporting software not

Potential challenges and disadvantages of developing this resource/capability internally are ...

- Need for continuous iteration based on customer feedback.

Potential challenges and disadvantages of acquiring this resource/capability externally are ...

- Weak integration between cleaning execution and digital output.- N



Choosing Your Organization

3

EXPLORE BUSINESS ECOSYSTEM

Investigate & Prioritize Sources of Critical Resources & Capabilities

Identify players within the ecosystem who could facilitate development of or access to these two critical resources and capabilities.

Critical Resource/Capability #1: Proprietary Mechanical Cleaning & Compliance Capability

Potential Hires and Early Team:

- Robotics / mechanical engineers with experience in

Supply Chain and Other Ecosystem Players:

- Component suppliers for brushes, motors, and waste

Potential Culture & Leadership Style:

- Engineering-driven but problem-first culture.- Safety- and compliance-by-design

Critical Resource/Capability #2: Digital Service & Data Integration Capability

Potential Hires and Early Team:

- Full-stack or data engineers with experier

Supply Chain and Other Ecosystem Players:

- Cloud and analytics platforms .- Academic c

Potential Culture & Leadership Style:

- Cross-functional collaboration between hardware, software, and commercial teams.



Choosing Your Competition

1

COMPETITION VS COLLABORATION

Identify with Whom to Compete

COMPETITION

List potential competitors who might be affected by the implementation of the core idea and anticipate their response.

Potential Competitors:

-
-
- Manual Rope Access Companies: (e.g., local window cleaning firms). They
-
-

Competitive responses in the relevant industries often take the form of price competition, rapid technology upgrades where firms attempt to slow competition by leveraging (capabilities)... pricing power, regulatory influence, customer relationships, and scale advantages.

That being said, competitors may be limited in their ability to respond quickly because of (commitments)... changing their existing business models & infrastructure eg., pivot to robotics, hardware re-engineering etc

COLLABORATION

Gauge the availability of complementary assets and identify potential partners.

The following resources and/or capabilities are critical for delivering value from the core idea and are difficult to acquire or build:

-
- Customer Access / Sales Channel: Access to building owners across D

Why?

Developing legal knowledge and a sales network from scratch is slow and capital-intensive.

A potential partner like Aviation Consultants (Droniq) may provide access to fast-track regulatory approvals (complementary asset). They may be interested in partnering, because... They are interested in selling airspace services.

A potential partner like Large Facility Management Agencies may provide access to contracts and early adopter sites (complementary asset). They may be interested in partnering, because... They are interested in less labour intensive options and to increase their profit-margin.

2

CONTROL VS EXECUTION

Identify How to Compete

CONTROL

Assess the core idea's risk of imitation.

The part(s) of the core idea most susceptible to replication (or work-around) by others is/are drone hardware and cleaning mechanics (key value drivers), because...

we won't have proprietary rights over hardware commodity.

By contrast, the element(s) of the core idea that will be difficult for others to replicate is/are building maintenance data-historical data integrated into the client's workflow (key value drivers), because...

High Switching Costs and losing long established building reports.

EXECUTION

Consider the venture's ability to stay ahead of competitors.

Execution and rapid iteration in the market will allow the venture to learn/improve upon operational safety (key value drivers). This offers advantage over competitors, because...

It is a high risk industry with strict regulation.

Executing quickly requires the venture to invest in acquiring and/or developing (key resources and capabilities)...

Investment in pilot training and acquiring licenses and integrating mechanical technology for precision cleaning.



Choosing Your Competition

3

EXPLORING OPTIONS

Narrow & Investigate Your Choices

Conduct commitment-free research and exploration about competitive options.

A viable competitive option/partner is Facility Management Agencies, which can be further investigated by...

- Interviewing Innovation Managers or Sales Team at FM agencies like Wisag or Strabag

Partnerships in this industry typically fail as a result of...

- There is a speed mismatch (Startup moves fast, Corporate moves slow) - Lack

Partnerships in this industry typically succeed when...

If the partner has an urgent strategic gap (e.g., Labor shortage or need for cost reduction) that they cannot solve internally.

Choosing to collaborate may be an irreversible choice in this context because...

Choosing to Collaborate (B2B2B) is irreversible because you lose direct contact with the end customer and become dependent on the partner's sales cycle.

Choosing to compete may be an irreversible choice in this context because...

Choosing to Compete (Service) is irreversible because it requires heavy fixed asset (vans/fleet) that require heavy investment. Additionally once we compete with existing FM agencies for market share, it will be difficult to collaborate with them in future.

Notes:



INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY STRATEGY

THE THINKERS

“Ideas Factory”



CUSTOMER

DELIVER value for EXISTING users:

Enhance value in a known way for existing players and their end users.

E.g. Dolby’s technology would be licensed to KLH and ultimately reach KLH’s end consumers through KLH’s finished products.



TECHNOLOGY

Develop GENERAL COMPONENT innovations:

Leverage a modular technology with generalizable components that can be easily transferred and integrated into existing value chains.

E.g. Dolby invented a generalizable technology that could reduce background noise in audio recordings without quality reduction.



COMPETITION

Orientation towards COLLABORATION and Investment in CONTROL:

Partner with incumbents (existing firms) or integrate into an existing value chain while maintaining control over the idea. Gain control through patents, trademarks, copyrights or trade secrets of a novel invention.

E.g. Dolby partnered with KLH and maintained control over the unique background noise reduction technology with patents.



ORGANIZATION

Leverage FUNCTIONAL RESOURCES:

Become the source of new inventions by building a team with talent in innovation, commercialization and IP management. Create an environment that will retain these team members. Occupy a position on the technology frontier and become a supplier of innovation and new standard.

E.g. Dolby was a PhD physicist and his skillset and insights led him to create Dolby Laboratories, an “idea factory” that could churn out new innovations in audio technology as the industry evolved.



VALUE CREATION HYPOTHESIS

VENTURE CREATES VALUE because its COMPONENT INNOVATIONS deliver value for EXISTING users:

The venture will create value for existing end users by inventing and integrating innovations into preexisting value chains.



VALUE CAPTURE HYPOTHESIS

VENTURE CAPTURES VALUE because it CONTROLS a key FUNCTIONAL RESOURCE:

The venture will capture value by developing a reputation for enforcing control over key functional resources and rationing access to secure bargaining power.



INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY STRATEGY

THE THINKERS

“Ideas Factory”



Use this worksheet, providing your choices for each field. Refer to Text Section 9.3 and Figure 9.7 for additional explanation.



CUSTOMER

Who are the final end customers and also the established firms serving those end customers who are willing to pay?



TECHNOLOGY

What is the technology used that could be integrated into an established firm's operations with limited integration costs?



COMPETITION

How might your venture cooperate with existing firms by focusing on control over the idea itself through investment in IP assets?



ORGANIZATION

What are resources/capabilities your venture would build to serve as complementary innovations for established firms while also integrating the capabilities for deal-making and IP protection?



VALUE CREATION HYPOTHESIS

How might your venture generate value for the customers of established firms through integrating the innovation into existing products/services or the existing value chain?



VALUE CAPTURE HYPOTHESIS

How might your venture use control over the idea and IP assets to extract significant and sustainable profit from established firms?



DISRUPTION STRATEGY

THE HUSTLERS

“Creative Destruction”



CUSTOMER

DISCOVER value for NEW users:

Focus on customer segments that are currently poorly served due to small size or niche demands.

For example, Warby Parker targeted hip, socially conscious yet budget-constrained students and young professionals. This was a customer segment that major eyeglasses retailers neglected.



TECHNOLOGY

Develop SPECIALIZED SYSTEM innovations:

Choose nascent technology that requires customer input and iterative improvement.

For example, Warby Parker leveraged its development of an efficient, low-cost global supply chain that produced high-quality, yet affordable eyeglasses. Customers could easily select and purchase these products using the venture's online retail technology.

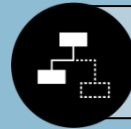


COMPETITION

Orientation towards COMPETITION and Investment in EXECUTION:

Engage in lean experimentation and leverage the venture's relatively small size to outrun and outperform incumbents in a specific area. Execute quickly and be fast to market to avoid rapid incumbent response.

For example, the Warby Parker team's fast pace, dedication to learning through execution, and focus on serving a neglected market in the eyeglasses industry helped the venture avoid major responses from traditional eyeglasses retailers like Luxottica.



ORGANIZATION

Build INTEGRATED CAPABILITIES:

Set up information gathering systems that allow for iterative product design changes to obtain continual, fast-paced growth. Leverage local talent with low acquisition costs and employees that can be attracted with minimal upfront cash.

For example, the team drew on prior experience in the eyeglasses industry to conceptualize and design a new, efficient supply chain that created a more affordable product.



VALUE CREATION HYPOTHESIS

VENTURE CREATES VALUE because its SYSTEM INNOVATIONS deliver value for NEW users:

The venture will create value for new users by developing a new value chain with a rate of improvement that likely outperforms existing chains.



VALUE CAPTURE HYPOTHESIS

VENTURE CAPTURES VALUE because it CONTROLS a key INTEGRATED RESOURCE:

The venture will capture value by achieving customer growth without an active and focused response from incumbents.



DISRUPTION STRATEGY

THE HUSTLERS

“Creative Destruction”



Use this worksheet, providing your choices for each field. Refer to Text Section 10.4 and Fig. 10.7 for additional explanation.



CUSTOMER

Who is the target customer, and who ideally is poorly served by existing firms and would benefit from an emerging technology?

Facility Management of Corporate Buildings(ex: Beiersdorf) and Property Management of Public Institutions (ex: TUHH,NIT) who doesn't want Human-risk involved, want more sustainable solution, want automated detailed report on cleanliness.



TECHNOLOGY

What new technology is your venture introducing that is unexploited by established firms and costly for established firms to adopt in the short term?

Hardware: A mechanical drone attachment (rotatory brush)Software



COMPETITION

How might your venture compete against incumbent firms by focusing on execution relative to control over the idea itself?

By becoming disruptive technology producer for more effective and faster cleaning operation comparing to manual cleaning (like e.g., Wisag,) and less water usage with better cleanliness than spraying drone based methods.



ORGANIZATION

What are the resources/capabilities that your venture would prioritize to create competitive advantage while allowing for continual experimentation and market learning?

We focus on execution speed by continuous experimentation and rap



VALUE CREATION HYPOTHESIS

How might your venture develop a system innovation and discover value for new users?

Creating value by minimizing safety risks, lowering water consumption, and providing digital documentation for compliance and maintenance insights.



VALUE CAPTURE HYPOTHESIS

How might your venture stay ahead and profit when there is a competitive threat? Why might existing firms be slow to respond?

Staying ahead by continuously experimenting and doing rapid prototyping, benefiting from incumbents' slow adoption due to high switching costs and legacy processes.



VALUE CHAIN STRATEGY

THE PARTNERS

“Core Competency”



CUSTOMER

DISCOVER value for EXISTING users:

Choose partners for whom you can enhance their value propositions and market power.

For example, Foxconn focused on the development of capabilities in precision, low-cost electronics manufacturing. This made Foxconn attractive for partnerships with companies like Atari in the early days. Low-cost manufacturing capabilities made electronics more affordable and more appealing to Atari's customers.



TECHNOLOGY

Develop SPECIALIZED COMPONENT innovations:

Facilitate the integration of new technology into established technology systems.

For example, Foxconn developed a specialized, precise, and dependable manufacturing process that could consistently supply electronic producers with essential components at low costs.



COMPETITION

Orientation towards COLLABORATION and Investment in EXECUTION:

Integrate into the existing value chain to create new value for existing users. Execute quickly to bring the best solution for a segment through an existing value chain.

For example, Foxconn integrated its electronics manufacturing into existing electronic product value chains. Their low costs made them an ideal candidate for collaboration among value chain players and their quick, efficient production strategy kept the venture ahead of competitors.



ORGANIZATION

Build FUNCTIONAL CAPABILITIES:

Form tightly knit teams with unique capabilities. Ensure that in competitive selection, you have priority in negotiations with existing value chain players.

For example, Foxconn's capabilities in precision electronics manufacturing at low costs gave the venture priority with existing value chain players. Ultimately, Foxconn grew to account for 40% of global electronics manufacturing.



VALUE CREATION HYPOTHESIS

VENTURE CREATES VALUE because its COMPONENT INNOVATIONS deliver value for EXISTING users:

The venture will create value for existing users and other value chain players by becoming a unique, vital link in the value chain.



VALUE CAPTURE HYPOTHESIS

VENTURE CAPTURES VALUE because it EXECUTES on key FUNCTIONAL CAPABILITIES:

The venture will capture value by executing on key functional capabilities that can be leveraged over value chain partners.



VALUE CHAIN STRATEGY

THE PARTNERS

“Core Competency”



Use this worksheet, providing your choices for each field. Refer to Text Section 11.3 and Fig. 11.8 for additional explanation.



CUSTOMER

Who might be the final end customers and also the established firms serving those end customers who are willing to partner?

We target large Facility Management (FM) agencies (e.g., Wisag.) in contract with Corporate HQs and High rise structures. We enhance their value proposition by enabling them to offer "Green, Safe, & Data-Driven" facade cleaning to their existing clients without needing to build the tech themselves. We solve their labor shortage crisis and increasing profit-margin.



TECHNOLOGY

What would be the technology that is centered on the integration of an emerging technology within the operations of an existing value chain?

Hardware: A mechanical drone attachment (rotatory brush)



COMPETITION

How might your venture cooperate with existing firms by focusing on execution over the idea itself to shape the bargaining position of your venture relative to the other value chain players?

By becoming the exclusive technology supplier for agencies we restrict competitor drone manufacturers (like Aeronex or KTV). We focus on execution speed. We provide certified pilots and ready-to-use drone mechanism, so they can use our tech faster than they could build it internally.



ORGANIZATION

How might your venture prioritize building a functionally specialized team with unique capabilities to fulfill an irreplaceable function in the value chain?

Unlike a standard drone cleaning companies, we will focus on regulatory support (permits), and maintenance. The solution will be less labour intensive, helping the agencies to maintain control over costs and resources.



VALUE CREATION HYPOTHESIS

How might your venture discover new value for customers of an existing firm through the integration of a specialized component innovation?

The venture creates value by enabling incumbent service providers to deliver safer, more compliant, and more cost-efficient cleaning for their existing customers.



VALUE CAPTURE HYPOTHESIS

How might the start-up serve a crucial, irreplaceable role in the value chain for existing firms as to gain consistent profit?

The venture captures value by executing a specialized, irreplaceable function within the value chain that partners cannot easily replace or internalize.



ARCHITECTURAL STRATEGY

THE BUILDERS

“Zero to One”



CUSTOMER

DELIVER value for NEW users:

Understand how to match specific stakeholders together to create and deliver value for all sides.

For example, Bloomberg's new idea of computer terminals with proprietary software essential to trading and investing delivered value to traders, investors, brokers, and more financial market participants.



TECHNOLOGY

Develop GENERAL SYSTEM innovations:

Develop either (1) a platform upon which others can build products or (2) a market intermediary.

For example, Bloomberg computer terminals were a general system innovation that gave financial professionals access to news, analytics, secure messaging, and more.



COMPETITION

Orientation towards COMPETITION and investment in CONTROL:

Focus on architecting a new value chain that creates distinct value not currently provided in the economy. Leverage this value chain to compete. Control the unique, new value chain to ultimately lead and shape an emerging ecosystem.

For example, Bloomberg created, controlled, and leveraged a new value chain to compete with traditional financial advisors and media providers.



RESOURCES & CAPABILITIES

Leverage INTEGRATED RESOURCES:

Monitor the needs of key stakeholders who create value and provide investments complementary to those of others. Work to ultimately position the venture as a market hub.

For example, Bloomberg's founding team was composed of former Wall Street traders who were familiar with the relevant stakeholders and their needs. The founding team leveraged these insights to create a platform for the investing community.



VALUE CREATION HYPOTHESIS

VENTURE CREATES VALUE because its SYSTEM INNOVATIONS deliver value for NEW users:

The venture will create value for new users by architecting a value chain that leverages interactions between complementary stakeholders.



VALUE CAPTURE HYPOTHESIS

VENTURE CAPTURES VALUE because it CONTROLS a key INTEGRATED RESOURCE:

The venture will capture value by developing sustainable control over the value created by different stakeholders.



ARCHITECTURAL STRATEGY

THE BUILDERS

“Zero to One”



Use this worksheet, providing your choices for each field. Refer to Text Section 12.3 and Fig. 12.6 for additional explanation.



CUSTOMER



TECHNOLOGY



COMPETITION



RESOURCES & CAPABILITIES

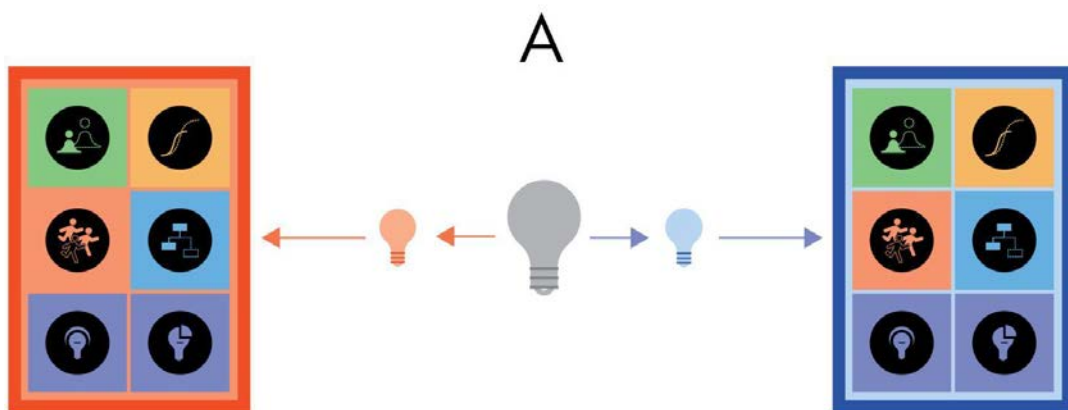


VALUE CREATION HYPOTHESIS



VALUE CAPTURE HYPOTHESIS

Test Two, Choose One



Using the following process, conduct a structured analysis of two alternative entrepreneurial strategies, propose a test to choose between them, and determine an appropriate path forward.

Step 1: Outline *Entrepreneurial Strategy A*.

Step 2: Repeat the process for *Entrepreneurial Strategy B*, an alternative but potentially viable entrepreneurial strategy.

Step 3: *Compare, Test, and Choose!*

Entrepreneurial Strategy A



Outline ***Entrepreneurial Strategy A*** for the venture on the entrepreneurial strategy canvas. Articulate the linkages between the choices of customer, technology, resources and capabilities, and competition. Evaluate the key hypotheses and the viability of the strategy.

Value Chain Strategy

 Idea

This resource is essential for value creation because it directly reduces the liability of newness by embedding the venture inside the customer's decision-making reality. It ensures that the service is designed around real procurement constraints, risk perceptions, and evaluation criteria, rather than hypothetical customer needs.

 Advantage

A specialized combination of mechanical cleaning capability and compliance-ready digital reporting that incumbents cannot easily internalize.

 Passion

Improving safety, sustainability, and transparency in urban building maintenance, driven by the founding team's strong passion for applying drone and robotics technologies to real-world industrial problems.

 Venture

Improving safety, sustainability, and transparency in urban building maintenance, driven by the founding team's strong passion for applying drone and robotics technologies to real-world industrial problems.

 Strategy

Value Chain Strategy — become a critical execution partner rather than a market disruptor.

 Business Model

B2B2B service contracts with cleaning and facility management companies; recurring service fees and premium compliance/documentation modules.

 Customer

- Primary (B2B): Facility management and professional

 Technology

Drone-assisted mechanical cleaning with brush-based deep cleaning, reduced water usage, and integrated visual/thermal documentation. Technology extends existing cleaning workflows rather than replacing them.

 Competition

Competes horizontally with traditional execution methods (rope access, heavy machinery) and emerging drone-based cleaning providers (e.g., KTV, Aeronex), while collaborating vertically with incumbent facility management and professional cleaning service providers.

 Organization

A cross-functional team focused on execution excellence: robotics integration, regulated field operations, and partner-facing digital service delivery.

 Value Creation Hypothesis

The venture creates value by enabling incumbent facility management and cleaning service providers to deliver safer, more compliant, and more cost-efficient façade cleaning for their existing customers. Value is created by reducing labor and insurance costs through drone-assisted execution, while enabling partners to upsell high-margin digital services, such as thermal audits and façade condition insights, therefore transforming a traditionally low-margin cleaning activity into a data-enhanced service offering.

 Value Capture Hypothesis

The venture captures value by executing a specialized, difficult-to-replace function within the value chain through a Hardware-as-a-Service model. Facility management firms pay a recurring monthly lease for the drone system and a per-project fee for data processing and reporting. This model creates recurring revenue and partner lock-in, as switching providers would require workforce retraining and result in the loss of accumulated operational and historical inspection data.



Coherence and Linkages

What **must be true** about customers, technology, organization, and/or competitors for the value creation and value capture hypotheses to be true? How do these choices **reinforce** each other?

- Incumbent cleaning providers are willing to outsource high-risk, high-access cleaning tasks.
- Customers value compliance, safety, and documentation more than owning new technology.
- Drone-assisted cleaning integrates into existing contracts without disrupting relationships.



Customer

The venture's competitive position will assist in creating value for target end consumers because...



Technology

The venture's core technology facilitates value creation for the target customer because...



Competition

The team's unique resources and/or capabilities provide the basis for capturing value through partnerships and/or competition because...



Organization

To capture value from the venture's core technology, the founders and early team must acquire/build the following resource/capabilities...



Strengths & Weaknesses

Major strengths and areas of consistency with this entrepreneurial strategy include...

- Strong fit with existing value chains-

The venture's value creation/capture hypothesis depends on the success of/belief that...

The strategy depends on being indispensable in execution, not on owning the customer relationship.

Potential weaknesses and areas of doubt with this entrepreneurial strategy are...

- Dependence on partner adoption- Slow

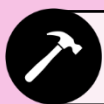
Customer TechnologyThe solution creates value because drone-assisted



Experimentation

Given the critical assumptions underlying the strategy, brainstorm three low-commitment experiments that could facilitate learning. Then, weigh the opportunity costs associated with conducting each experiment.

Criticality: Rank the key assumptions underlying the strategy.	Fidelity: Briefly describe an experiment to learn more about each assumption. Highlight how the outcome will inform decision-making.	Opportunity Costs: Identify & weigh the opportunity costs of each experiment.
1. Assumption: Cleaning companies will subcontract high-access façade cleaning	Experiment: Paid pilot with one cleaning provider on a campus site	Cost: Low revenue, high learning speed
2. Assumption: Compliance documentation is a key buying driver	Experiment: Test digital report prototypes with facility managers	Cost: Minimal development time
3. Assumption: Drone cleaning is accepted if embedded in existing workflows	Experiment: Shadow integration into an existing long-term contract	Cost: Operational coordination effort



Implementation

What two or three concrete actions could the founders take to develop the idea or increase their hypotheses' likelihood of being true?

- Secure 1–2 pilot partnerships with fa



Viability

Overall, how much uncertainty is there associated with how the proposed strategy will create value for customers and capture value from the opportunity?

High

Moderate

Low

☐☐☐

What critical assumption(s) is/are unlikely to be effectively tested through low-commitment experimentation?

Key uncertainties include:- Technical feasibility and stability of integrating comm

Entrepreneurial Strategy B



Repeat the process for ***Entrepreneurial Strategy B***, an alternative but potentially viable entrepreneurial strategy with value creation and/or value capture hypotheses that differ from *Entrepreneurial Strategy A*.

Disruption Strategy



Idea

This resource drives value creation by enabling the venture to execute quickly on specialized system innovations that deliver novel solutions to underserved users currently ignored by incumbents.. By prioritizing rapid market feedback and continuous experimentation, the venture secures a foothold while established firms remain hindered by organizational inertia.



Advantage

A specialized combination of mechanical cleaning capability and compliance-ready digital reporting that incumbents cannot easily internalize.



Passion

Improving safety, sustainability, and transparency in urban building maintenance, driven by the founding team's strong passion for applying drone and robotics technologies to real-world industrial problems.



Venture

A B2B service provider offering high-environment-friendly deep façade cleaning for Facility Management of Corporate Buildings and Public Institutions.



Strategy

Disruption Strategy — become a disruptor in cleanliness market partner rather than a value-chain partner.



Business Model

B2B service contracts with facility management companies directly; recurring annual service contracts and provide automated documentation.



Customer

Facility Management of Corporate Buildings(ex: Beiersdorf) and Property Management of Public Institutions (ex: TUHH,NIT) who doesn't want Human-risk involved, want more sustainable solution, want automated detailed report on cleanliness.



Technology

Drone-assisted mechanical cleaning with brush-based deep cleaning, reduced water usage, and integrated visual/thermal documentation. Technology replacing existing cleaning workflows.



Competition

By becoming disruptive technology producer for more effective and faster cleaning operation comparing to manual cleaning (like e.g., Wisag) and less water usage with better cleanliness than spraying drone based methods.



Organization

We focus on execution speed by continuous experimentation and



Value Creation Hypothesis

Creating value by minimizing safety risks, lowering water consumption, and providing digital documentation for compliance and maintenance insights.



Value Capture Hypothesis

Staying ahead by continuously experimenting and doing rapid prototyping, benefiting from incumbents' slow adoption due to high switching costs and legacy processes.



Coherence

What **must be true** about customers, technology, organization, and/or competitors for the value creation and value capture hypotheses to be true? How do these choices **reinforce** each other?

- Facility Management of the Corporate companies are willing to upgrade their cleaning procedure.
- R&D team are able to mass product the soft-touch brush based cleaning Drones.
- Compitators are slow-enough to do back-engineering and clone the technology.
- _____



Customer

The venture's competitive position will assist in creating value for target end consumers because...



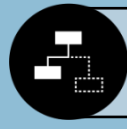
Technology

The venture's core technology facilitates value creation for the target customer because...



Competition

The team's unique resources and/or capabilities provide the basis for capturing value through partnerships and/or competition because...



Organization

To capture value from the venture's core technology, the founders and early team must acquire/build the following resource/capabilities...



Strengths & Weaknesses

Major strengths and areas of consistency with this entrepreneurial strategy include...

- Complete control over technology development, pricing, and market

Potential weaknesses and areas of doubt with this entrepreneurial strategy are...

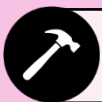
- Dependence on companies willings to a



Experimentation

Given the critical assumptions underlying the strategy, brainstorm three low-commitment experiments that could facilitate learning. Then, weigh the opportunity costs associated with conducting each experiment.

Criticality: Rank the key assumptions underlying the strategy.	Fidelity: Briefly describe an experiment to learn more about each assumption. Highlight how the outcome will inform decision-making.	Opportunity Costs: Identify & weigh the opportunity costs of each experiment.
1. Facility Managers in the DACH region are sufficiently motivated by regulatory liability (ex: German WHG water laws) or achieve Sustainability, to switch to a new, unproven provider.	Instead of pitching a cleaning drone, approach 10 target organizations (e.g., universities, corporate HQs) offering a free "Facade Runoff Compliance Assessment." Interview their Legal or Sustainability Officers as well to see if they currently document wastewater disposal and if they fear audits.	Time & Focus: This experiment requires significant time spe
2. Mechanical brush with specific force feedback can remove "heavy soot" without scratching sensitive glass coatings that spray-only drones cannot achieve.	Construct a simple handheld rig (pole + brush head) with the intended bristles and water flow. Manually clean a heavily soiled ground-level patch at a client site to the exact specifications of the flight system.	False Confidence: This experiment has low fidelity re
3. Public institutions and corporate managers will pay a premium (or approve invoices faster) for a Digital Service Report containing thermal diagnostics and "before/after" heat maps, solving their "verification gap."	Manually collect data (using a handheld thermal camera) and design a high-fidelity "Dummy Report" in Photoshop. Present this to a Facility Manager as if it were the standard automated output of the drone.	Market Signaling: Showing a perfect r



Implementation

What two or three concrete actions could the founders take to develop the idea or increase their hypotheses' likelihood of being true?

- Secure 1–2 pilot partnerships with facility/Pr



Viability

Overall, do you believe this strategy is potentially viable?

This strategy is potentially viable because it targets an under-served niche in the DACH region where strict environmental regulations and heavy urban soot render existing manual and spray-drone solutions either prohibitively expensive or ineffective.

What critical assumption(s) is/are unlikely to be effectively tested through low-commitment experimentation?

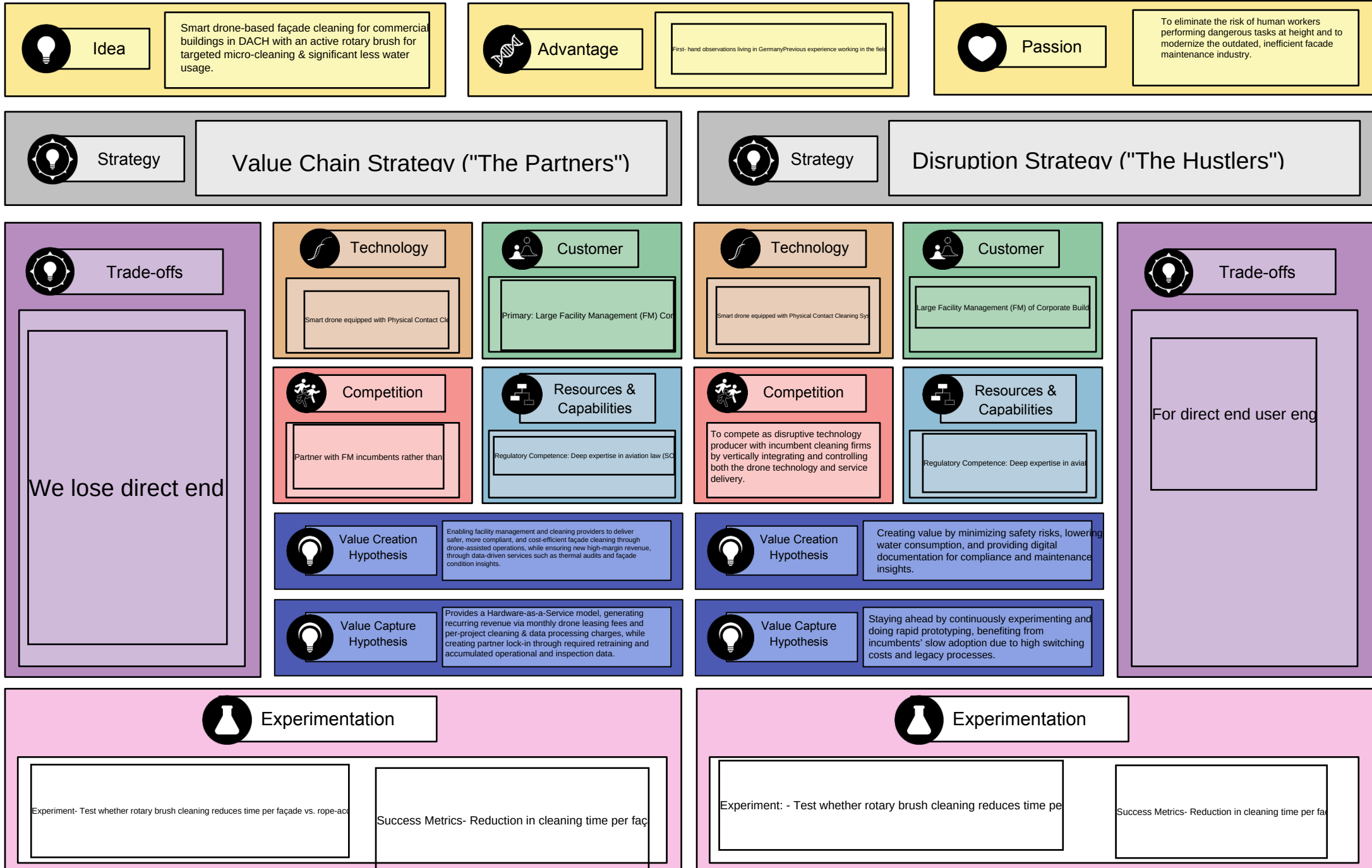
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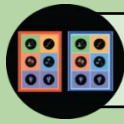
Compare, Test, and Choose!



Evaluate how these two strategies are different from each other and propose an experiment that would allow you to ***choose one***.

TEST TWO, CHOOSE ONE SUMMARY





Compare

What are the key differences between these strategies? Why can't the entrepreneurs do both at the same time? What will they learn about in one strategy but not in the other (and vice versa)?

- Value Chain: Lose direct end user engagement, no immediate operational learning and

Test

What test could the founding team run to choose between these alternatives?
Does doing one or the other impose costs on pivoting?

- Interview both FM agencies & direct end users & gauge their willingness



Choose One!

Now it is time to choose.

Between the two strategies, which strategy helps the entrepreneur(s) achieve their broader reasons for becoming an entrepreneur (i.e., entrepreneurial passion) and leverages their experience (“unfair advantage”)?

Value Chain Strategy

Which strategy is the most straightforward to implement and allows the entrepreneur to “just do it”?

Disruption Strategy

Is it *really* time to choose? Not necessarily...

Now that you have decided between *Entrepreneurial Strategy A* and B as your preferred approach, develop an *Entrepreneurial Strategy C*.

Continue iterating new strategies and choosing between them until you have developed two approaches that are equally viable in your estimation. At this point, stop!

Choose the Strategy that satisfies your priorities and move forward!

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03.01.26